
INCOMING MESSAGE

--DECRYPTING --

--COMPLETE: 100%--

TO: MAJOR HOANG DUAN

CO: MORNING STAR ASSAULT GROUP

FROM: COLONEL DAVIS HELLER

CO: TOOTH OF YMIR 08-02-3031 14:33:18

Good morning Major. My intelligence team has just completed a tactical review of the current situation on Betelgeuse.

After the initial combat drop of Warrior House Hiritsu, on 9 July, the 1st Defenders and Andurien, 2nd Battalion, under Major James Humphries and lances from our own forces successfully took the fight to Hiritsu. We can confirm of their initial 3 companies of 'Mechs 50% were destroyed in the Search and Destroy mission. Hiritsu then changed tactics – moving from confrontation to guerrilla tactics and avoidance, leading to the death of Major James Humphries.

For the record, I've reviewed your Striker Lances gun camera footage and you did good. I also managed to get hold of a copy on the Anduriens gun camera footage and radio logs, although not via direct channels. Your response time was excellent, and your aggressive deployment saved the lives of the rest of Major Humphries Lance. His Marauder had exploded in the first 20 seconds of the ambush under concentrated enemy fire. It would seem they know exactly who was piloting that Marauder and concentrated fire. My bet is the Capellan Maskarova were well informed as to the Majors deployment and 'Mech. I find no fault in the actions of Lt. Ragget-Riley, and she should be commended on her valiant efforts. Unfortunately, Lt. Col. Garabaldi is spinning it a different way and covering his own back. His official report, which for the record I have not read, probably states that the Mercenary forces response was inadequate. He even seems to have set his own personal war correspondent from the Andurien News Network on us with that hatchet job of a documentary she published.

The fallout is this: our Planetary Invasion contracted officially ended on 30 July 3031. The Anduriens activated the continuation clause – and have legally declared victory. This shifts our contract from one of open warfare, to an after-action Garrison contract for the next 12 months. Our new orders are to garrison the Aldis Industries and Firmir Commercials industrial plants. The Anduriens are despatching technical teams each supported by a company of Andurien foot infantry for security. Those teams will work to bring the plants online and producing war materials. My suggestion to you is that you follow your contract to the letter Major. Secure Firmir commetials and that area only. Keep your combat patrols within a few km of the facility. Both Warrior House Hiritsu and Kamata are destroyed as effective combat forces but have enough units to wage guerrilla conflicts in the wilderness. All transport of supplies will be by DropShip.

Lt. Col. Garabaldi has ceased all Search and Destroy missions and is fortifying his forward operating base at Avin Lakes. Biden and Kingston, the two main planetary cities are still under Capellan control with a Battalion of troops (including 2 heavy armor companies) dug into each city, and the Lt. Col. has no intention of taking the fight to them.

In summary, follow your contract, smile and wave.

<Update 10-03-3031 10:08:24>

By now I'm sure you have watched the national address by Duchess Catherine Humphries to the people of the Duchy of Andurien. Despite the death of her son, Major James Humphries, She has committed the Anduriens to winning this war and has promised that additional forces will be despatched to Betelgeuse to "crush the Capellans" and "integrate Betelgeuse fully into the Dutchy of Andurien".

My intel team has looked into the reality of this and believe that it will be at least 3-6 months before any of the Duchies other formations can be redeployed from their own theatres of operations.

The last two months have been quiet. There have been no sightings of any enemy forces. The civilian technical forces have arrived and are repairing the sabotage committed by the Capellan's on the facilities. We have obtained a number of prototype ER Large Lasers which have been designed using the specs from the Help Memory Core. The capacitors on them are not however, up to the StarLeague's design specs causing random heat spikes. In test firing, one of my Mech's fired two of these simultaneously and a heat spike shut down her Mech, almost cooking of her ammo. I'm not sure I can recommend them, but they sure do have a long range (effectively 970 meters).

<Update 01-28-3132>

I can confirm that the 3rd and 4th Defenders of Andurien Regiments have arrived and are setting up a forward deployment base half-way between us and Avin Lakes. Although they have taken some casualties from their last deployment, they are still 85% combat effective. With these additional forces, I expect Lt. Col. Garabaldi to launch an offensive against Biden by the end of February. We, however, have received no new orders....

<Update 02-14-3132>

At 09:34 hours, local time, we detected an emergence wave from the L1 LaGrange point. 3 hours later, 6 Union class DropShips entered the atmosphere and headed straight for the 3rd and 4th's position. At 14:40 hours, local time, Lt. Col. Menlo Drews (CO: 3rd Defenders of Andurien)

confirmed engagement with the Capellen Confederation's Protectorate Guard, the Chancellors own Body Guard unit, sworn to give their life to the Confederation. Our forces received no communication from the Anduriens, and no requests for reinforcements.

By 19:00 hours combat had ceased. Unofficial reports have come to me that the Protectorate Guards, 2 heavy BattleMech battalions, including at least 48 Marauder BattleMechs, was completely destroyed to the last 'Mech, but in return the 3rd and 4th suffered 40% casualties and at least 60% complete material losses. Currently, their combat effectiveness is less than 20% after battle damage.

The Cappellan's threw a big punch today, Major. They might be down, but they are not out.

<Update 05-15-3032. 06:23:14>

Satellites have detected a huge emergence wave at the L1 LaGrange Point. At least 10 JumpShips, including 3 Starlord's. Optical and IR Telescopes have detected drive plumes from at least 30 DropShips burning inbound in tight formation. The 1st Anduriens intel team are in a state of panic. They are unaware of any Capellan Forces that are capable of deploying in that level or force. Lt. Col. Garabaldi is deploying recon AeroSpace. Our orders are – Hold.

<Update 05-15-3032. 10:07:10>

Recon AeroSpace from the 1st Defenders have confirmed, the Big Mac is here. From the number of DropShips, all five of the McCarron's Armored Cavalry regiments has deployed. We have detected a total of 60 DropShips entering the upper atmosphere. Andurien Military Intelligence are still in a state of denial – their last report to me was this can't be McCarron's as their combat effectiveness was reported as ineffective after their engagements with the Davions on Sarna in '29.

<Update 05-15-3032. 10:10:54>

We have 12 DropShips entering low atmosphere above our theatre of operations Major. Three are heading for you, and Overlord, Seeker and Mule, alongside 6 aerospace fighters, 1 Heavy Sq, 1 Medium and 1 Light. We have 6 DropShips heading our way. We have not yet received any other orders. If we are looking at facing a full Regiment, then, I kid you not Major, we are in the fight of our lives. My suggestion – start loading your non-combat personnel and equipment on your DropShips. Our order remain unchanged. We hold!